A Collector's Guide to the

German Gew. 88 "Commission" Rifle

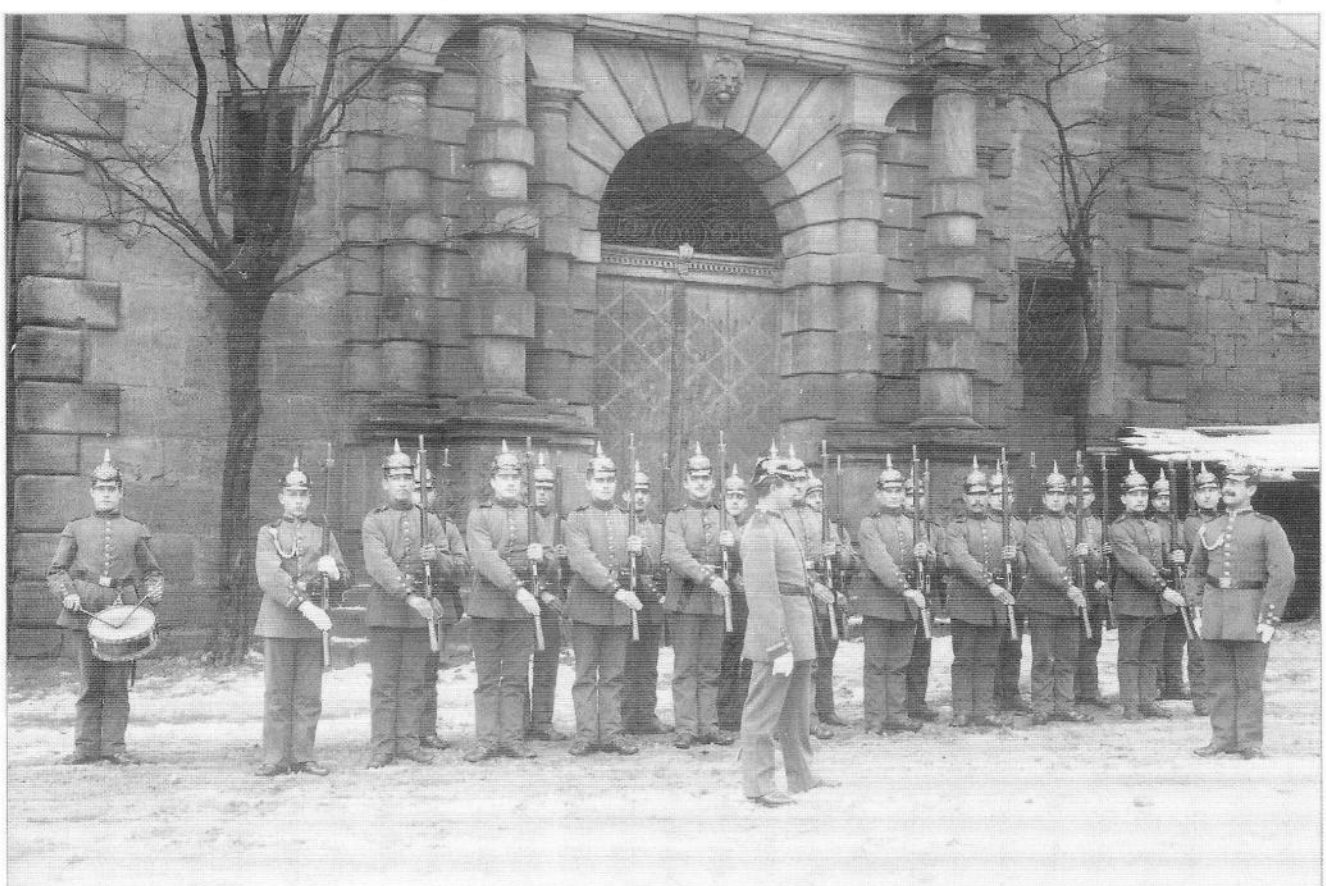
Paul S. Scarlata

A COLLECTOR'S GUIDE

to the

GERMAN GEW. 88 "COMMISSION" RIFLE

Germany's First Modern Military Rifle, the Infanteriegewehr 88



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Photos by James Walters

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PHOTO ON PREVIOUS PAGE: *1898. An honor guard of the 7th Bavarian Infantry Regiment.* (Stuart Mowbray collection)

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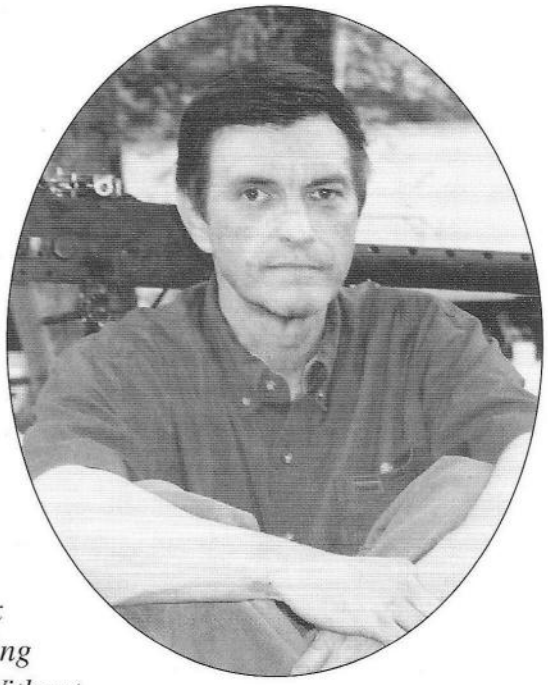
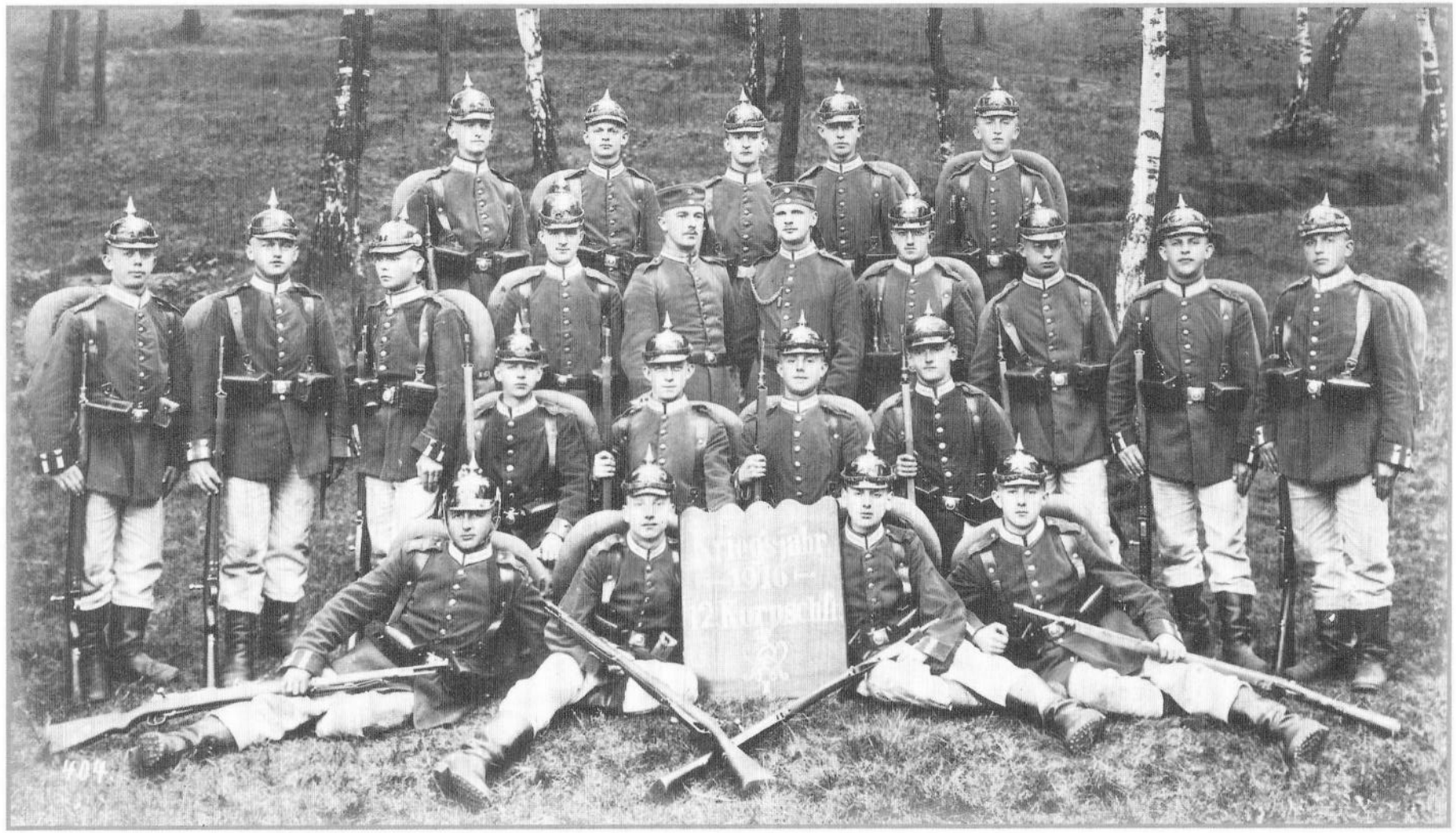


This book is dedicated to my good friend and fellow collector of oddities, Vince DiNardi. From the very beginning of my writing career, Vince has been the source of many of the classic military firearms I have photographed and test fired. I would call him and say, "I'm looking for 'one of these' do you have one?" Whereupon he would answer, "Oh, sure. Someplace around here." Then, miraculously, a few weeks later, a box would arrive on my doorstep containing some hard-to-find rifle or handgun. Without Vince's apparently limitless collection of military small arms, his knowledge, connections, generosity, cheerfulness and help there is no way I could have accomplished what I have. Over the years, I have only known a small number of people about whom I can say "...they have never let me down." Vince is one of them.

"Mille grazie Vincenzo!"



1916. A group of youthful looking recruits pose for a photo. Note, even at this late date, some of them are armed with Infanteriegewehre 88/05 while the others have Infanteriegewehre 98. (Stuart Mowbray collection)

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